



The Association for Music in International Schools

Audition Instructions for all AMIS Ensembles

Jazz Ensembles:

Audition uploads open: 10 April 2026

Audition uploads close: 1 May 2026 at 11:59 PM GMT

All other Auditioned Ensembles:

Audition uploads open: 1 October 2026

Audition uploads close: 11:59 PM GMT on 23 October 2026

Late auditions will not be considered.

Eligibility & Submission Limits

School & Student Requirements

- Membership: Schools must be AMIS members. Students must be active members of their school's relevant music program.
- Grade Levels:
 - High School Honor Ensembles: Grades 9–12 (Years 10–13).
 - Middle School Honor Ensembles: Grades 6–8 (Years 7–9).
 - Junior Honor Ensembles: Grades 4–5 (Years 5–6) (Internally auditioned).
- Regions: Schools must audition for their specific region (Asia, Europe, Africa, Latin America).
 - *Exceptions:* Middle East/South Asia schools may choose their region, but can only choose one. Jazz and Rock Band festivals are global. Schools may audition for a festival in a different region where one does not exist in their own.

Submission Caps

- Standard Limit: 6 auditions per instrument/voice part per school.
- Exceptions:
 - African Band: Up to 12 per instrument.
 - Latin American Orchestra: Up to 14 per instrument.

Instrument Specifics

- Piccolo: Submit ONLY the combined flute/piccolo audition and will be considered for both instruments.
 - Doubling: Students on Bass Trombone, English Horn, or Eb Clarinet may submit two auditions (e.g., Bass Trombone and Trombone). *Note: For Jazz Auditions, Bass Trombone is combined with the Trombone audition.*
 - Vocals: AMIS is gender-inclusive; teachers must select the voice part matching the student's vocal range.
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Preparation & Materials

- Repertoire: Use Set 1 materials downloaded directly from the *recent* AMIS website. Do not use old downloads of Set 1.
 - Jazz: Improvisation is required. See the *Jazz Terminology Guide* section below for style terms.
 - Preparation: Follow all stylistic/technical indications and listen to professional recordings of the excerpts, if available.
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Recording Guidelines

Teachers must be present or nearby during recording. Home recordings or those made by private teachers are not accepted. Teachers should listen back and ensure proper recording quality, including balance of the metronome click, so that the student is heard clearly with no distortion or other interfering sounds. Taking the time to adjust microphone placement and levels will ensure the best possible audition.

Technical Specifications

- Format: **MP3 only** (Other audio file types and video are not accepted). **Verify playback after uploading.** If your file is in a different format, please convert to MP3.
- File Naming: **Title_StudentName**. Use letters/numbers only; no accents or symbols. School name is optional.
- Structure: Record separate files for each item (e.g., 1 file for scales, 1 file for the excerpt).
- Anonymity: No speaking. Do not announce the student's name or school.

Audio Quality & Editing

- No Editing: Do not add reverb, splice, cut, or studio-engineer files (including AI usage). You may only trim silence at the start/end.
- Settings: Disable auto-reverb (common in apps like Soundtrap).
- Microphone: Point toward the performer and away from accompaniment.

Metronome Rules

- Use a single tone (no distinct bell/click for downbeats).
- Ensure the metronome does not subdivide beats.
- Follow specific start/stop instructions on the sheet music.

- Digital apps and computerized metronomes are permitted, but the sound must be a standard click or tone. Do not use drum loops, backing tracks, or percussion recordings.
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Submission & Integrity

- Screening: Teachers should only submit recordings that meet the standard for an advanced ensemble.
- Upload: Use the AMIS Awards Platform. Ensure files are in the matching slots.
- Verification: Teachers must attest that the file is unedited and recorded during the current audition period (Feb–April 2026 for Jazz; Aug–Oct 2026 for others).

Commitment:

By auditioning for an AMIS ensemble, students affirm their genuine intention to accept a place if offered. The AMIS selection process is highly competitive, and each spot represents a significant opportunity for a deserving musician.

Listing an AMIS ensemble on a résumé, CV, or application without having officially participated is considered a misrepresentation. If it is discovered that an individual has falsely claimed AMIS ensemble membership without attending, AMIS reserves the right to formally intervene. This could include notifying the institution, university, or employer to which the false claim was made. Such actions may have serious consequences for academic or professional opportunities.

*Additionally, any student who withdraws from an AMIS ensemble after auditioning **will be ineligible to audition the following year**, unless the withdrawal is due to an unforeseen or unavoidable circumstance as determined by the ED in collaboration with the school music teacher.*

AMIS upholds the highest standards of artistic and academic integrity, and we expect all participants to do the same.

Adjudication

- Process: Blind and anonymous listening by a committee of at least two adjudicators.
 - Feedback: Due to anonymity, individual feedback is not provided.
 - Results: Sent via email to the school music teacher.
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Appendix: Jazz Terminology Guide

Guide to more jazz specific terms used in the jazz audition materials:

- *Comp* - accompany with chords in appropriate rhythmic style, possibly with light fills at the ends of phrases.
- *Walk* - walking bass pattern, supporting rhythm, possibly outlining chord structures and filling in scale steps.
- *Time* - play in appropriate rhythmic style, possibly with light fills or pushes at the end of phrases.

- *Solo* - play a stylistically appropriate solo section, using scales appropriate to the chords indicated. Pianists might play chords in the left hand while improvising a melodic pattern in the right or use block chords. Guitarists might use a stylistically appropriate mixture of chords and melody.
- *Scat* - vocal improvisation using nonsense syllables (bah dah, bat n doo-yah, and so on).